

Decoding the 2026 Tamil Nadu Assembly Election

Political Shifts, Swing Seats & Electoral Competitiveness

An analysis of regional volatility,
party transitions and competitive constituencies
between 2021 and 2026.

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Tools:
PostgreSQL | Tableau | Canva



Project Objective

This analysis explores how Tamil Nadu's political landscape changed between 2021 and 2026.

- Which regions experienced highest volatility?
- How many constituencies flipped parties?
- Did elections become more competitive?

Goal:

Identify regional shifts, party transitions,
and emerging swing constituencies.



Dataset & Methodology

Datasets Used

- tn_2021_results.csv
(Constituency-level election results)
- tn_2026_results.csv
(2026 election results)
- constituency_master.csv
(Region, district and constituency mapping)

Tools & Workflow

- PostgreSQL
Data Cleaning & SQL Analysis
- Tableau
Visualisation & Dashboard
- Canva
- Storytelling & Presentation

Method:

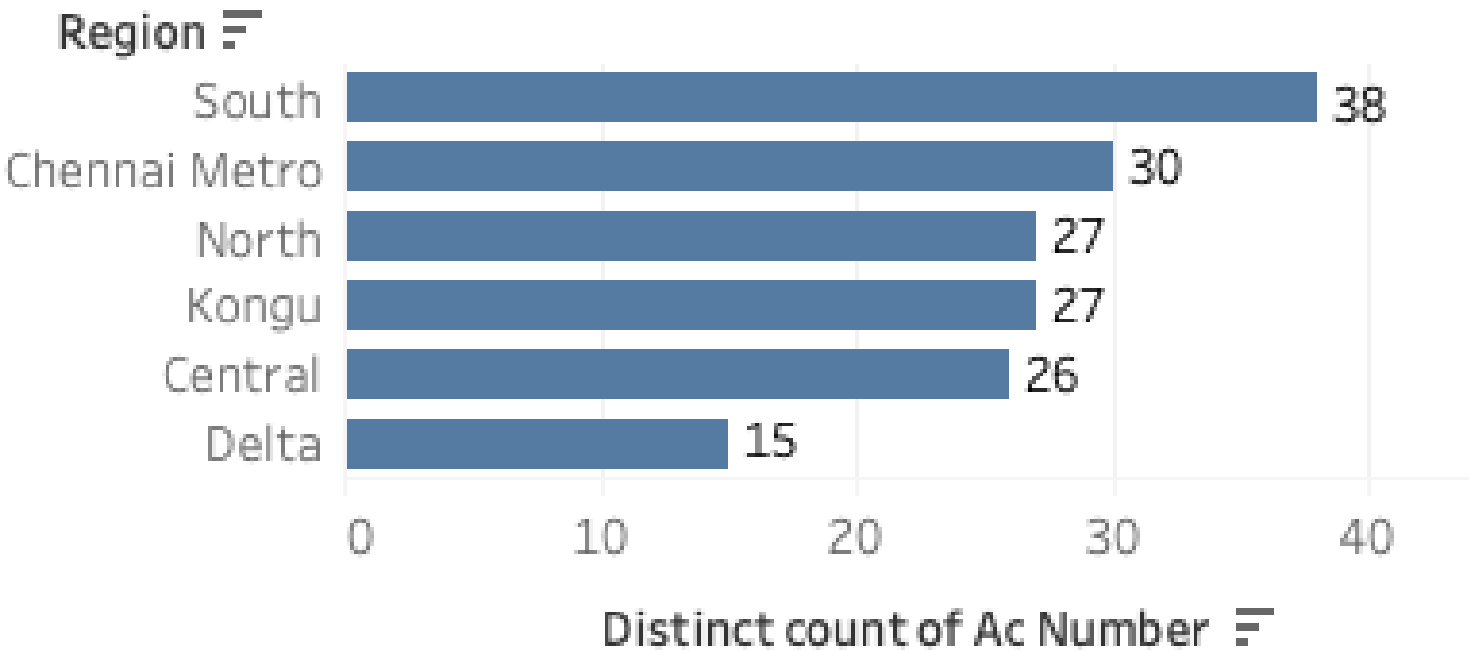
1. Identified winning candidates by constituency
2. Compared 2021 vs 2026 winners
3. Measured constituency flips
4. Calculated competitiveness using victory margins
5. Visualised regional volatility and party transitions



Story 1:

Political Volatility Was Uneven Across Regions

Political Volatility by Region



Key Findings:

Some regions experienced significantly higher constituency shifts between 2021 and 2026, suggesting changing voter preferences.

South recorded the highest political volatility (38 flipped constituencies), followed by Chennai Metro (30).

Delta showed the lowest volatility (15), indicating relatively stable voting patterns.

Insight:

The 2026 election was not uniform across Tamil Nadu. Political shifts were concentrated in specific regions, while others remained comparatively stable.



Story 2: Constituency Flips Revealed Concentrated Party Competition

Party-to-Party Seat Shifts

Party 2021	Party 2026										
	AIADMK	AMMK	BJP	CPI(M)	DMDK	DMK	INC	IUML	PMK	TVK	VCK
AIADMK						15	1	1		26	1
BJP						2				2	
CPI(M)										1	
DMK	22	1		1				1	3	65	
INC			1		1	1				11	
PMK	2									2	
VCK	1					1				1	

Key Findings:

Winning parties changed in 163 constituencies between 2021 and 2026.

The most common transition was:
DMK → TVK (65 constituencies),
indicating significant vote shifts toward TVK.

Most transitions occurred among major regional parties,
suggesting concentrated competition rather than fragmented voting.

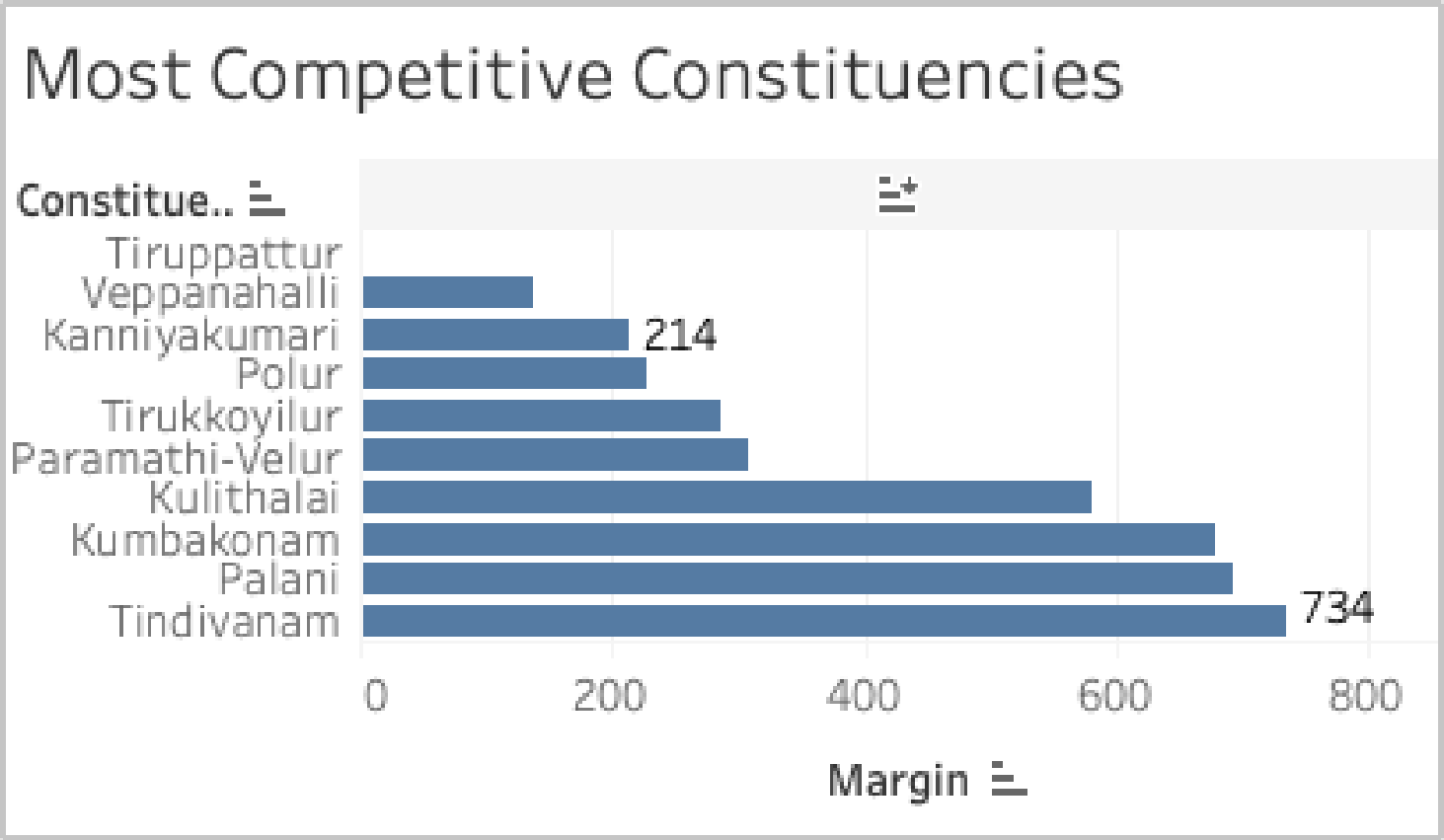
Insight:

Political change was driven by seat transfers between established parties and emerging competitors, rather than entirely new voting blocs.



Story 3:

Victory Margins Shrunk, Making Elections More Competitive



Key Findings:

Multiple constituencies were decided by narrow victory margins, suggesting increased electoral competitiveness in 2026.

Close margins indicate potential swing seats that may influence future elections.

Average Victory Margin

2021: 22,871 votes

2026: 16,784 votes

Interpretation:

The average victory margin declined by ~27%, suggesting tighter contests and increased electoral competitiveness in 2026.

Insight:

A small change in voter preference could alter outcomes in closely contested seats.



Connecting the Findings: What Defined the 2026 Election?

Combined Interpretation

Political shifts were concentrated in specific regions.

These shifts translated into constituency-level party changes, while declining victory margins suggest tighter contests.

Together, the findings indicate increasing electoral competitiveness rather than stable party dominance.

Headline Finding:

Tamil Nadu's 2026 election was shaped by regional volatility, party transitions and increasingly competitive constituencies.

Connecting the Findings: What Defined the 2026 Election?

Regional Volatility



Constituency Flips



Closer Electoral Margins



More Competitive Politics



Limitations & Considerations

Data Constraints:

- Analysis focused on constituency outcomes rather than individual candidate behaviour.
- Turnout analysis was not included, as 2026 turnout data required external sourcing.
- Reserved constituency patterns (SC/ST vs General) were excluded.
- Findings are limited to available election datasets and derived SQL calculations.

Interpretation Caution

Political shifts do not always indicate long-term voter realignment.

Regional volatility may reflect local factors not captured in this analysis.

Key Note:

This analysis identifies patterns,
not causal explanations for voter behaviour.



Editorial Recommendation

Future election coverage should focus on:

1. High-volatility regions
(where constituency shifts are concentrated)
2. Closely contested constituencies
(with shrinking victory margins)
3. Emerging swing seats
(where small voter changes may alter outcomes)

The 2026 election suggests that political competition is becoming increasingly localised and competitive.

Monitoring volatile regions may provide earlier signals of future electoral shifts.

Final Takeaway:

Tamil Nadu's next major political shift may be determined less by traditional strongholds and more by competitive swing constituencies.



Thank You

Thank you for viewing.
Questions & feedback are welcome.

GitHub Repository:

<https://github.com/ShilpaBanerjee/tn-election-analysis-2026>

LinkedIn:

(To be added before submission)

Video Walkthrough:

(To be added after upload)

